

Phishing Email Analysis

From: noreply.paypal@securemygateway.com

Subject: Paypal Account Suspension



Dear Customer,

Your PayPal account has been temporarily restricted. We have found suspicious activity on credit cards linked to your PayPal account.

You must confirm your identity to confirm that you own the credit card.

To maintain account security, please provide documents that confirm your identity.

[Log in to Paypal](#)

After you complete the requested task, we will review the account and contact you about its status within 5 working days.

Thank you for your attention to this problem.

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1. Obtain a Sample Phishing Email

A sample phishing email impersonating **PayPal** was selected for analysis. The email claims that the user's PayPal account has been temporarily restricted because of suspicious activity. It asks the user to confirm their identity and provide documents.

Email Subject: PayPal Account Suspension

Sender: noreply.paypal@securemygateway.com

2. Examine Sender's Email Address for Spoofing

The sender's email address is:

noreply.paypal@securemygateway.com

The email claims to be from PayPal, but the actual domain is **securemygateway.com**. The domain does not match the organization being impersonated. The use of the word "paypal" in the username can make the address appear legitimate.

3. Check Email Headers for Discrepancies

Email headers can provide information about the actual source of an email. Important fields include **From, Reply-To, Return-Path, Received, SPF, DKIM, and DMARC**.

The provided screenshot does not contain the complete email headers. Therefore, the SPF, DKIM, DMARC, and mail-routing information cannot be verified from the screenshot alone.

4. Identify Suspicious Links or Attachments

The email contains a **"Log in to Paypal"** button. The button asks the recipient to log in after claiming that the account has been restricted.

No attachment is visible in the provided email screenshot.

The actual destination of the login button should be checked carefully before clicking it.

5. Look for Urgent or Threatening Language

The email uses language intended to create urgency and concern. Examples include:

- "Your PayPal account has been temporarily restricted."
- "We have found suspicious activity..."
- "You must confirm your identity..."
- "Please provide documents that confirm your identity."

Such messages may pressure users into taking immediate action without verifying the email.

6. Note Any Mismatched URLs

The email displays a button labeled **"Log in to Paypal."** However, the screenshot does not show the actual destination URL.

The destination URL should be checked by hovering over the button without clicking it. If the destination points to an unrelated or suspicious domain, it would be a strong indication of phishing.

7. Verify Spelling or Grammar Errors

The email does not contain many obvious spelling or grammar mistakes. However, some other language-related warning signs are present:

- The greeting is generic: **"Dear Customer"**
- The email uses **"Paypal"** instead of the standard **"PayPal"** branding.
- The message uses generic wording rather than providing specific account information.
- It requests identity documents from the recipient.

8. Summary of Phishing Traits Found

The following phishing characteristics were identified:

Phishing Trait	Observation
Suspicious sender address	noreply.paypal@securemygateway.com
Domain mismatch	Sender uses securemygateway.com
Brand impersonation	Email claims to be from PayPal
Urgent message	Account is claimed to be temporarily restricted
Suspicious activity claim	Used to create fear and urgency
Identity verification	User is asked to confirm identity
Personal documents	User is asked to provide documents
Suspicious login button	"Log in to Paypal"
Generic greeting	"Dear Customer"
Attachment	No attachment visible
URL verification	Actual destination is not visible in screenshot